

Make Hard Work Your Passion: Planning, Featuring Marie Mouchet

Marie Mouchet, VP & CIO Colonial Pipeline Company

Pat Summitt was not one for winging it. Yes, she worked hard, but more than that, she also made it her business to know where she was going and what she was doing on a daily basis. Pat always had a plan.

She said, “Plan your work and work your plan. You have to work toward a goal in an organized fashion. You don’t just show up in March and win a championship. You work every day in a systematic fashion. You have a long-range plan, but you also have a short-range plan. More important, you have to plan your daily activity and know what your goal is.”

Pat kept a calendar that tracked her yearly, monthly, and weekly goals. Knowing where she was going helped her zero in on what she needed to focus on in the day-to-day. Every night she would review the plan for the following day. She had to do this because Pat was a master of multi-tasking. She regularly juggled multiple responsibilities from running practices, attending games, and delivering presentations to filling out paperwork, making dinner, and taking care of her family.

Here are two simple practices to help you focus small in your day-to-day progress towards your goal.

First, make a list. Plan your workday by pinpointing your task and prioritizing the order in which to complete them. The more specific you can be, the better. Try to group similar tasks together. That way you can maintain focus and keep your mental energy up throughout the day.

Second, focus on what is doable. Sometimes a job can feel overwhelming when you look at how far you have to go to get to the finish line. In these moments, concentrate on the small things that can be done first. Ask yourself, “What is something I can do in this moment to make progress toward my goal?”

Big wins are born out of devotion to daily improvement. Many times, all you need to see to get ahead is just the next step. When hard work is your passion, keep the big picture in mind and devote yourself to making it come to life one frame at a time.